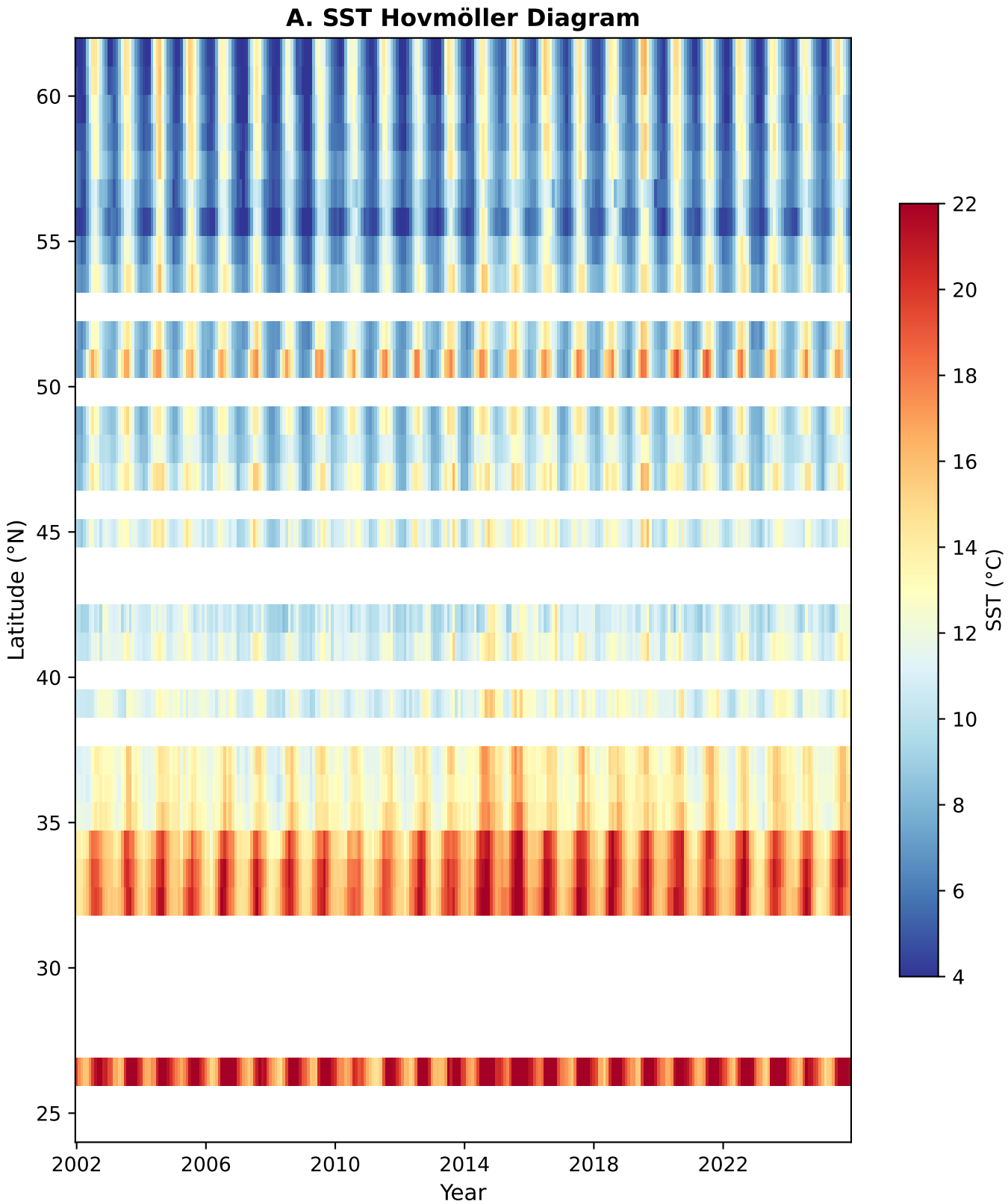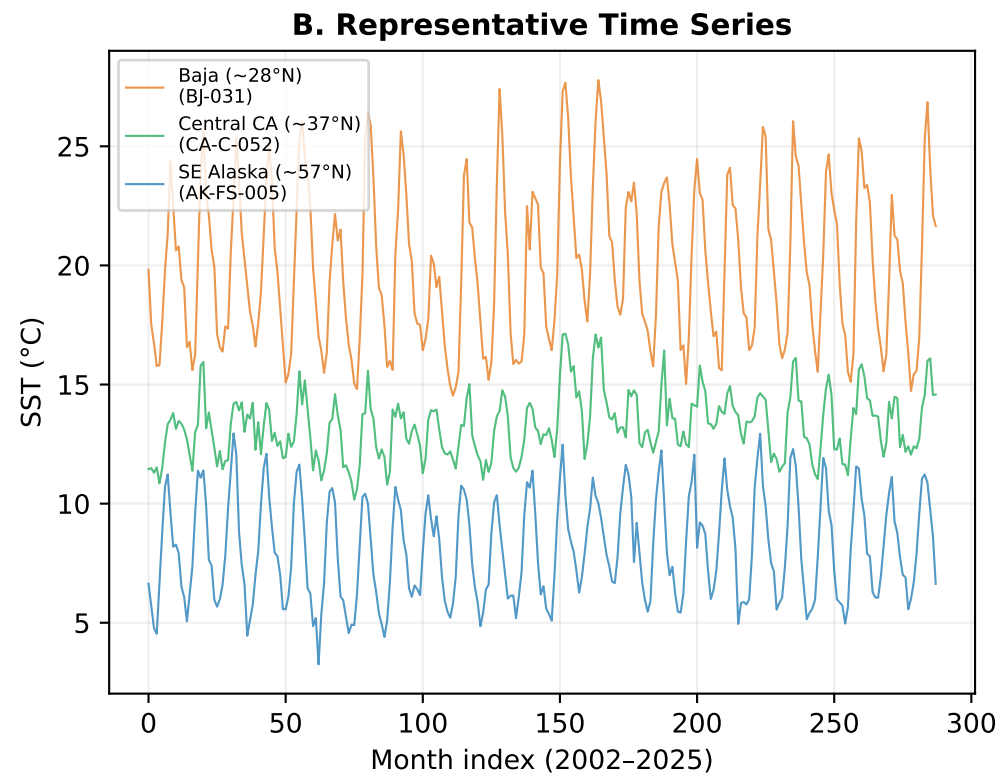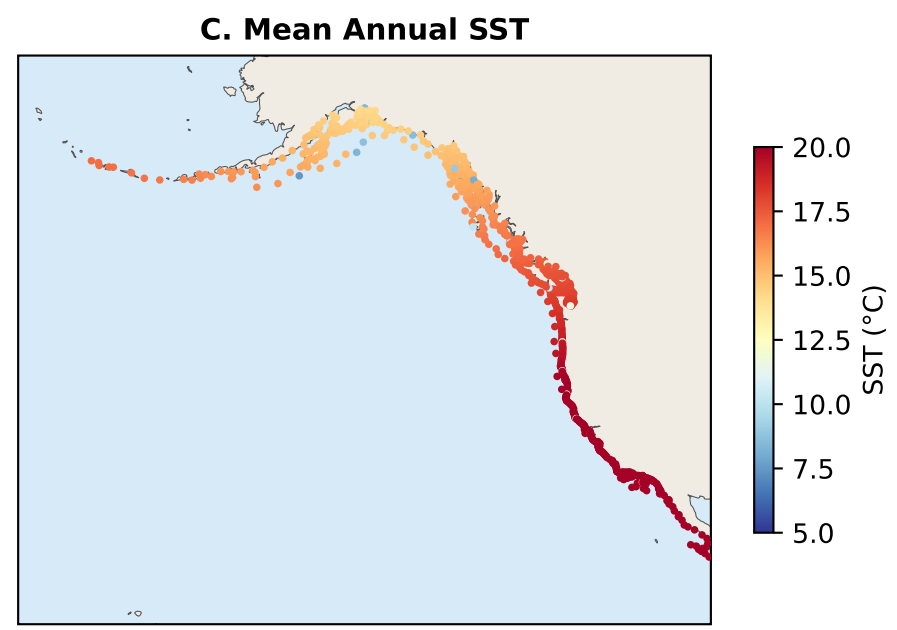SST Forcing: Latitudinal Gradient & Temporal Dynamics